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Iron-type golf club head

Abstract

A golf club head includes a body having a toe region, a heel region, a sole weight bar extending between the toe region and the heel region, and a face insert that is coupled to the body and wraps about the sole weight bar. The golf club head defines a sole having a toe segment, a medial segment, and a heel segment, and the face insert at least partially defines the medial segment of the sole. A gap is disposed between the sole weight bar and the face insert. The gap extends entirely about an outer periphery of the sole weight bar and is disposed between the sole weight bar and each of a face portion of the face insert, a sole portion of the face insert, and a back portion of the medial segment of the sole.

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Background/Summary

CROSS REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) This patent application is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 17/344,245, filed on Jun. 10, 2021, which is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 16/788,898, filed on Feb. 12, 2020, and now issued as United State U.S. Pat. No. 11,033,788, each of which is incorporated herein by reference in its entirety.

REFERENCE REGARDING FEDERALLY SPONSORED RESEARCH OR DEVELOPMENT

(1) Not applicable.

SEQUENCE LISTING

(2) Not applicable.

BACKGROUND

1. Field of the Disclosure

(3) The present disclosure relates to golf clubs, and more specifically to an iron-type golf club head that includes a face insert.

2. Description of the Background of the Disclosure

(4) Different types of golf clubs are used to effect different types of shots, based on a golfer's location and ball lie when playing a hole on a golf course. An iron is a golf club that is used to make a variety of shots on a golf hole, for example, approach shots, bunker shots, chips, etc.

(5) Conventional iron-type golf club heads may include a face insert that is attached to a body. For example, a conventional face insert may be in the form of 2-D plate that is welded around the periphery of the insert to adjoin to the body. In some configurations, conventional face inserts may define a more complex geometry, such as cup faces and partial cup faces (e.g., L-cups) that are welded around the entire periphery of the insert to adjoin to the club head body. Generally, the

complex geometry defined by conventional cup face inserts attempts to move the weld further away from the high stress areas of the face.

(6) A major disadvantage of conventional cup faces is that a longer weld bead is required around the entire perimeter of the face insert, when joining it to the body, which increases club head weight and manufacturing time. In addition, conventional cup face inserts are welded to a portion on the sole of the club head body at a location that is at most only half of the width of the sole back from the front of the face (e.g., at most half of the way between a leading edge and a trailing edge). This creates an extremely stiff portion in the middle of the sole and prevents the face and sole from flexing.

(7) Therefore, a need exists for an iron-type golf club head with an improved face insert design that provides more efficient manufacturability and increased performance.

SUMMARY

(8) The present disclosure provides an iron-type golf club head that includes a body and a face insert. A topline and a sole of the iron-type golf club head are integrated into the face insert to reduce a welding perimeter distance, improve control over a thickness of the face insert, and maintain maximum flexibility in the face insert and the sole.

(9) In some embodiments, the present disclosure provides a golf club head that includes a body having a toe region, a heel region, and a sole weight bar extending between the toe region and the heel region, a sole defining a toe segment, a medial segment, and a heel segment, and a face coupled to the body. A gap is arranged between the sole weight bar and a rear surface of the face. The gap extends around an outer periphery of the sole weight bar and is formed between the sole weight bar and the medial segment of the sole.

(10) In some embodiments, the present disclosure provides a golf club head that includes a body having a toe portion, a heel portion, and a sole portion, a weight bar extending between the toe portion and the heel portion, and a face coupled to the body. A gap is arranged between the weight bar and the sole portion. The gap extends around an outer periphery of the weight bar and is formed between the weight bar and a rear surface of the face.

(11) In some embodiments, the present disclosure provides a golf club head that includes a body having a toe region, a heel region, and a sole weight bar extending between the toe region and the heel region, a sole defining a medial segment, and a face insert coupled to the body at an interface between the face insert and the body and having a face portion. A gap is arranged between the sole weight bar and the face portion of the face insert. The gap extends around an outer periphery of the sole weight bar and is formed between the sole weight bar and the medial segment of the sole.

(12) In some embodiments, the present disclosure provides a golf club head including a body with a toe region and a heel region, a sole weight bar extending between the toe region and the heel region, and a face insert that is coupled to the body and wraps about the sole weight bar. The golf club head defines a sole having a toe segment, a medial segment, and a heel segment, and the face insert at least partially defines the medial segment of the sole. A gap is disposed between the sole weight bar and the face insert. The gap extends entirely about an outer periphery of the sole weight bar and is disposed between the sole weight bar and each of a face portion of the face insert, a sole portion of the face insert, and a back portion of the medial segment of the sole.

(13) In some embodiments, the present disclosure provides a golf club head including a body with a toe region and a heel region, a sole weight bar extending between the toe region and the heel region, and a face insert coupled to the body and including a face portion and a sole portion that wrap around the sole weight bar. A gap is disposed between the sole weight bar and the face insert. The gap extends entirely about an outer periphery of the sole weight bar and is disposed between the sole weight bar and each of the face portion, the sole portion, and a back portion of the body.

(14) In some embodiments, the present disclosure provides a golf club head including a body with a toe region and a heel region, a sole weight bar extending between the toe region and the heel region, and a face insert coupled to the body at an interface between the face insert and the body.

The golf club head defines a sole having a toe segment, a medial segment, and a heel segment, and the face insert includes a face portion and a sole portion that wrap around the sole weight bar. The sole portion at least partially defines the medial segment of the sole, and a gap is disposed between the sole weight bar and the face insert. The gap extends entirely about an outer periphery of the sole weight bar and is disposed between the sole weight bar and each of the face portion, the sole portion, and a back portion of the medial segment of the sole.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

- (1) FIG. 1 is an exploded bottom, back, right isometric view of an iron-type golf club head according to the present disclosure;
- (2) FIG. 2 is a top, front, left isometric view of the iron-type golf club head of FIG. 1 with a face insert coupled to a body;
- (3) FIG. 3 is a bottom, back, right isometric view of the iron-type golf club head of FIG. 2;
- (4) FIG. 4 is a front view of the iron-type golf club head of FIG. 2;
- (5) FIG. 5 is a back view of the iron-type golf club head of FIG. 2;
- (6) FIG. 6 is a cross-sectional view of the iron-type golf club head of FIG. 2 taken along line 6-6 of FIG. 4;
- (7) FIG. 7 is a top, front, right isometric view of the iron-type golf club head of FIG. 2 illustrating weld lines;
- (8) FIG. 8 is a top view of the iron-type golf club head of FIG. 2 illustrating weld lines;
- (9) FIG. 9 is a bottom view of the iron-type golf club head of FIG. 2 illustrating weld lines; and
- (10) FIG. 10 is a top, back, right isometric view of the iron-type golf club head of FIG. 3 illustrating weld lines.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(11) The present disclosure is directed to an iron-type golf club head that is manufactured using a multi-piece design, and that includes a face insert attached to a body. In particular, an iron-type golf club head of the present disclosure includes a body and a face insert that is coupled to the body, and that does not require welding around its entire periphery. Unlike conventional face inserts, the sole and the topline of the club head may be integrated into and formed by the face insert, which only requires welding along the interface between the body and the face insert. In particular, welding along the interface between the body and face insert may only occur in a sole-topline direction along the club head (e.g., a vertical direction when the sole is resting on the ground and the club is at address, or a direction generally perpendicular to a heel-toe direction). The lack of heel-toe direction welds required to couple the face insert to the body substantially reduces the length of the weld bead required during manufacturing, which, in turn, reduces a weight of the club head and improves manufacturing efficiency.

(12) In addition, with the face insert defining the sole and only requiring sole-topline-extending welds to couple to the club head body, the welds are arranged away from impact locations on the face insert. In this way, for example, the thickness defined by the face insert may be controlled with tighter tolerances, especially in high stress areas on the face insert. Further, the iron-type golf club head according to the present disclosure may separate (e.g., form a gap between) a sole weight bar formed in the body and the sole formed by the face insert. This may provide a lower center of gravity (e.g., move the center of gravity in a direction toward the sole) and allow the highest possible amount of face and sole flex, which improves performance.

(13) Referring now to FIGS. 1-5, an iron-type golf club head **100** is shown in accordance with the present disclosure. The iron-type golf club head **100** includes a body **102** and a face insert **104**, which may be coupled to one another after machining of the body **102**. In some embodiments, the

face insert **104** may be manufactured from a different material than the body **102**. For example, the body **102** and the face insert **104** may be manufactured from different metal materials.

(14) The iron-type golf club head **100** defines a toe side **106**, a heel side **108**, a front side **110**, a top side **112**, a bottom side **114**, and a rear side **116**. The body **102** includes a toe region **118**, a medial region **120**, a heel region **122**, and a sole weight bar **124** extending through the medial region **120** and between the toe region **118** and the heel region **122**. The medial region **120** is arranged between the toe region **118** and the heel region **122**. The sole weight bar **124** is arranged adjacent to the bottom side **114**.

(15) In general, the medial region **120** of the body **102** is devoid of material other than the sole weight bar **124** extending between the toe region **118** and the heel region **122**. With the body **102** including only the sole weight bar **124** in the medial region **120**, a club face, a sole, and a topline of the iron-type golf club head **100** in the medial region **120** may be defined entirely by the face insert **104** as will be described herein. The face insert **104** is designed to fit between the toe region **118** and the heel region **122** (e.g., the face insert **104** is arranged in the medial region **120**) and fill at least a portion of the void therebetween.

(16) In the illustrated embodiment, a portion of the face insert **104** is designed to extend or wrap around the sole weight bar **124**. For example, the face insert **104** includes a top portion **126**, a face portion **128**, a sole portion **130**, and a back portion **132**. A section of the face portion **128**, the sole portion **130**, and the back portion **132** combine to form a generally U-shaped cavity that is designed to extend or wrap around the sole weight bar **124**, when the face insert **104** is coupled to the body **102** (see, e.g., FIG. 6).

(17) Referring to FIGS. 2-5, the iron-type golf club head **100** defines a topline **134** extending laterally in a heel-toe direction **136** along the top side **112**, and a sole **138** extending laterally in the heel-toe direction **136** (see FIGS. 4 and 5) along the bottom side **114**. The topline **134** includes a top-toe segment **140**, a top-medial segment **142**, and a top-heel segment **144**. The top-medial segment **142** of the topline **134** extends along the medial region **120** and is formed by the top portion **126** of the face insert **104**. That is, the portion of the topline **134** arranged within the medial region **120** is formed entirely by the top portion **126** of the face insert **104**. This differs from conventional iron-type golf club heads with a face insert where the topline is typically formed by a combination of the body and the face insert, or solely by the body.

(18) Similar to the topline **134**, at least a portion of the sole **138** is formed entirely by the face insert **104**. For example, the sole **138** includes a sole-toe segment **148**, a sole-medial segment **150**, and a sole-heel segment **152**. The sole-medial segment **150** of the sole **138** extends along the medial region **120** and is formed by the sole portion **130** of the face insert **104**. That is, the portion of the sole **138** arranged within the medial region **120** is formed entirely by the sole portion **130** of the face insert **104**. This differs from conventional iron-type golf club heads with a face insert where the sole is typically formed by a combination of the body and the face insert, or solely by the body. For example, as described herein, conventional face inserts are typically welded to a portion on the sole of the body at a location that is at most only half of the width of the sole back from the front of the face. In other words, the sole of conventional iron-type golf club heads with a face insert is formed by the face insert from a leading edge (e.g., an edge of the sole adjacent to the front side) to a location at most only half of the way between the leading edge and a trailing edge (e.g., an edge of the sole adjacent to the back side). The remaining portion of the sole is formed by the body, for example, from the location at most only half of the way between the leading edge and the trailing edge to the trailing edge of the sole. Contrary to conventional iron-type golf club heads, the topline **134** and the sole **138** of the iron-type golf club head **100** are integrated into the face insert **104**, which simplifies the manufacture of the iron-type golf club head **100** by only requiring welds in a sole-topline direction **146** at the interface between the body **102** and the face insert **104**, thereby providing several performance benefits.

(19) Referring specifically to FIGS. 4 and 5, the toe region **118**, the medial region **120**, and the heel

region **122** are defined by lines or planes **P1** and **P2** that extend through the iron-type golf club head **100** at an interface between the face insert **104** and the laterally-inner edges of the body **102**. As illustrated in FIGS. **4** and **5**, the toe region **118** and the heel region **122** are arranged at laterally-opposing ends of the body **102**, and the medial region **120** is arranged laterally between the toe region **118** and the heel region **122**.

(20) The toe region **118** includes a toe portion **154** of the body **102** that is defined by a portion of the body **102** between a distal end of the toe side **106** and the plane **P1**. A toe plane **T** may intersect the top side **112** of the toe portion **154** at a toe-topline intersection point **156** along the topline **134** where the slope of a line tangent to the topline **134** is approximately zero (e.g., a point where a line tangent to the periphery of the top side **112** is approximately parallel to the ground at address). The toe plane **T** extends through the toe portion **154** in the sole-topline direction **146** (e.g., a vertical direction from the perspective of FIGS. **4** and **5**) to a toe-sole intersection point **158**.

(21) The heel region **122** includes a heel portion **160** of the body **102** that is defined by a portion of the body **102** between a distal end of the heel side **108** and the plane **P2**. The heel plane **H** may intersect the top side **112** at a heel-topline inflection point **162** (e.g., a point where the periphery of the top side **112** transitions from concave down to concave up). The heel plane **H** extends through the heel portion **160** in the sole-topline direction **146** (e.g., a vertical direction from the perspective of FIGS. **4** and **5**) to a heel-sole intersection point **164**. The heel portion **160** includes a hosel **166** that extends from the heel portion **160** at an angle (e.g., a lie angle) in a direction away from the toe portion **154**. The hosel **166** defines a hosel cavity **168** within which a shaft (not shown) may be inserted for coupling to the iron-type golf club head **100**. In some embodiments, a ferrule (not shown) may abut or be at least partially inserted into the hosel **166**.

(22) The topline **134** may extend along an outer periphery of the top side **112** from the heel-topline inflection point **162**, along the top portion **126** of the face insert **104**, to the toe-topline intersection point **156**. The top-toe segment **140** may extend along the top side **112** of the toe portion **154** between the plane **P1** and the toe-topline intersection point **156**, and the top-heel segment **144** may extend along the top side **112** of the heel portion **160** between the plane **P2** and the heel-topline inflection point **162**. A toe periphery **170** defines a generally curved shape and may extend around the toe portion **154** from the toe-topline intersection point **156** to the toe-sole intersection point **158**.

(23) The sole **138** may extend along a periphery of the bottom side **114** from the toe-sole intersection point **158**, along the sole portion **130** of the face insert **104**, to the heel-sole intersection point **164**. The sole-toe segment **148** may extend along the bottom side **114** of the toe portion **154** between the toe-sole intersection point **158** and the plane **P1**, and the sole-heel segment **152** may extend along the bottom side **114** of the heel portion **160** between the plane **P2** and the heel-sole intersection point **164**.

(24) As described herein, the face insert **104** is arranged within the medial region **120**. The face portion **128** is arranged on the front side **110** and defines a striking surface **172** that extends laterally in the heel-toe direction **136** between the planes **P1** and **P2** and vertically in the sole-topline direction **146** between the topline **134** and the sole **138**. The striking surface **172** includes a plurality of grooves **174** formed therein that extend laterally in the heel-toe direction **136** along at least a portion of the striking surface **172**. Each of the grooves **174** is spaced from an adjacent groove **174** in the sole-topline direction **146** (e.g., vertically spaced from the perspective of FIG. **4**).

(25) Referring now to FIGS. **1** and **6**, the sole weight bar **124** includes a weight **176** that is received within a weight cavity **178** that is formed in the sole weight bar **124** and that extends laterally in the heel-toe direction **136** along the sole weight bar **124**. The weight **176** may be fabricated from a higher density material than the material from which the body **102** is fabricated. In one embodiment, the weight **176** may be fabricated from a tungsten material. The weight **176** within the sole weight bar **124** is configured to lower a center of gravity defined by the iron-type golf club head **100**, which aids in performance (e.g., higher launch angle).

(26) With specific reference to FIG. 6, the face insert **104** may be formed as a unitary component (e.g., a single piece of material). The face portion **128** and the striking surface **172** are generally planar and are angled relative to a plane normal to the ground (not shown) on which the sole **138** may rest at address (e.g., a loft angle). This angle may be adjusted based on the type of iron (e.g., 2-iron, 7-iron, wedge, etc.) that the iron-type golf club head **100** is formed into. A rear plane Pr tangent to a first point on the rear face of the sole weight bar **124** is disposed at an angle relative to a front plane Pf tangent to a second point on the front face of the sole weight bar **124**.

(27) In the illustrated embodiment, the top portion **126** of the face insert **104** extends away from the face portion **128**. Specifically, the top portion **126** extends from the top side **112** of the face portion **128** in a direction toward the rear side **116**. In the illustrated embodiment, the top portion **126** extends toward the rear side **116** at a downward angle (e.g., angled toward the bottom side **114**). At the bottom side **114** of the face portion **128**, the sole portion **130** extends toward the rear side **116** to form a leading edge **180** arranged adjacent to the front side **110** to a trailing edge arranged adjacent to the rear side **116**. In the illustrated embodiment, the sole portion **130** defines a generally rounded or curved shape. A top plane Pt is defined by a planar segment of the top face of the sole weight bar **124**, and a sole face of the sole weight bar **124** is concavely curved relative to the top plane Pt. In addition, the sole face of the sole weight bar **124** and the sole portion **130** are convexly curved in a front-rear direction relative to a ground plane Pg.

(28) The back portion **132** extends in a direction toward the top side **112** (e.g., upwardly from the perspective of FIG. 6) from the trailing edge **182** to a location between the top side **112** and the bottom side **114**. In the illustrated embodiment, the back portion **132** extends toward the top side **112** a distance sufficient to cover the sole weight bar **124**, when the iron-type golf club head **100** is viewed from the rear side **116** (see, e.g., FIG. 5).

(29) In general, the geometry defined by the face insert **104** conforms to the geometry defined by the laterally-inner edges of the toe portion **154** and the heel portion **160**. In this way, for example, when the face insert **104** is coupled to the body **102**, the outer surfaces of the face insert **104** are arranged flush with the outer surfaces of the toe portion **154** and the heel portion **160** of the body **102**.

(30) As described herein, a section of the face portion **128** (e.g., adjacent to the bottom side **114**), the sole portion **130**, and the back portion **132** combine to form a generally U-shaped cavity that is designed to extend or wrap around the sole weight bar **124**. In the illustrated embodiment, the face insert **104** extends around the sole weight bar **124**, such that the face insert **104** is separated from the sole weight bar **124**. That is, a gap **184** is formed between the sole portion **130** and the sole weight bar **124**. In the illustrated embodiment, the gap **184** extends around an outer periphery of the sole weight bar **124** and is formed between the sole weight bar **124** and each of the face portion **128**, the sole portion **130**, and the back portion **132**. The separation or gap **184** between the sole weight bar **124** and the face insert **104** keeps the center of gravity of the iron-type golf club head **100** low (e.g., in a direction toward the sole **138**) and maintains the highest amount of flex possible in the face portion **128** and the sole **138**, which improves club head performance (e.g., improved distance, accuracy, forgiveness, etc.).

(31) The rear side **116** of the face insert **104** may be generally devoid of material, other than the top portion **126** and the back portion **132**. In this way, for example, the iron-type golf club head **100** may define a generally open back cavity (e.g., a back cavity that is devoid of club head material), which further aids in lowering the center of gravity defined by the iron-type golf club head **100**.

(32) As described herein, the topline **134** and the sole **138** can be integrated into the face insert **104**, which only requires welding in the sole-topline direction **146** at the interface between the face insert **104** and the body **102** to couple the face insert **104** to the body **102**. Referring to FIGS. 7-10, the interface between the face insert **104** and the body **102** (highlighted using bold lines) is aligned entirely along the sole-topline direction **146**. In the illustrated embodiment, the interface between the body **102** and the face insert **104** includes a first interface **186** between the laterally-inner edge

of the toe portion **154** and the face insert **104** and a second interface **188** between the laterally-inner edge of the heel portion **160** and the face insert **104**. Each of the first interface **186** and the second interface **188** is aligned along the sole-topline direction **146**.

(33) With the first interface **186** and the second interface **188** being aligned along the sole-topline direction **146**, the iron-type golf club head **100** only requires welds along the sole-topline direction **146** to couple the face insert **104** to the body **102**. For example, to manufacture the iron-type golf club head **100**, the face insert **104** may be inserted into the medial region **120**, such that the face insert **104** is flush with the toe portion **154** and the heel portion **160**. Welding may then occur along the first interface **186** and the second interface **188** to couple the face insert **104** to the body **102**.

(34) The design and properties of the iron-type golf club head **100** provide several advantages over conventional iron-type golf club heads. For example, the lack of heel-toe direction **136** welds across the topline **134** and/or the sole **138** reduces a weld perimeter distance during manufacture, which results in weight being saved by having a shorter weld bead length. In addition, welding time is reduced, which results in manufacturing cost savings. Further, the ability to move the welds farther away from the impact location on the face portion **128** (e.g., the first interface **186** and the second interface **188** are arranged on the laterally-outer edges of the striking surface **172**) provides greater control and tighter tolerances over the thickness of the face insert **104**, especially in the high stress areas. Further still, the separation between the face insert **104** and the sole weight bar **124** allows for the maximum possible amount of face and sole flexibility. Each of these advantages drive performance increases for the iron-type golf club head **100** over conventional iron-type golf club heads.

(35) As noted previously, it will be appreciated by those skilled in the art that while the disclosure has been described above in connection with particular embodiments and examples, the disclosure is not necessarily so limited, and that numerous other embodiments, examples, uses, modifications and departures from the embodiments, examples and uses are intended to be encompassed by the claims attached hereto. The entire disclosure of each patent and publication cited herein is incorporated by reference, as if each such patent or publication were individually incorporated by reference herein. Various features and advantages of the invention are set forth in the following claims.

INDUSTRIAL APPLICABILITY

(36) Numerous modifications to the present disclosure will be apparent to those skilled in the art in view of the foregoing description. Accordingly, this description is to be construed as illustrative only and is presented for the purpose of enabling those skilled in the art to make and use the invention. The exclusive rights to all modifications which come within the scope of the appended claims are reserved.

Claims

1. An iron-type golf club head, comprising: a body including a toe region and a heel region, the toe region and the heel region each defining a portion of a top line and a portion of a sole of the iron-type golf club head; a sole weight bar extending between the toe region and the heel region; and a face insert that is coupled to the body and wraps about the sole weight bar, wherein the sole defines a toe segment, a medial segment, and a heel segment, the face insert at least partially defining the medial segment of the sole, wherein a gap is disposed between the sole weight bar and the face insert, wherein the gap extends entirely about an outer periphery of the sole weight bar and is disposed between the sole weight bar and each of a face portion of the face insert, a sole portion of the face insert, and a back portion of the body, wherein the gap defines: a first thickness between the face portion of the face insert and a first face of the sole weight bar; and a second thickness between the back portion of the body and a second face of the sole weight bar, and wherein the first thickness and the second thickness are each less than a thickness of the sole weight bar measured

between the first face and the second face along a front-rear direction.

2. The iron-type golf club head of claim 1, wherein a weight is disposed within a weight cavity of the sole weight bar.

3. The iron-type golf club head of claim 1, wherein the body and the sole weight bar comprise different materials.

4. The iron-type golf club head of claim 1, wherein the sole weight bar is coupled to the body at a first location within the toe region and at a second location within the heel region.

5. The iron-type golf club head of claim 1, wherein the gap includes: a front gap defined between the face portion and a front face of the sole weight bar; and a rear gap defined between the back portion and a rear face of the sole weight bar.

6. The iron-type golf club head of claim 1, wherein the face portion, the sole portion, and the back portion define a U-shaped cavity that extends entirely about the sole weight bar.

7. The iron-type golf club head of claim 1, wherein the sole weight bar is positioned entirely below a geometric center point of the face portion of the face insert.

8. An iron-type golf club head, comprising: a body including a toe region and a heel region, the toe region and the heel region each defining a portion of a top line and a portion of a sole of the iron-type golf club head; a sole weight bar extending between the toe region and the heel region; and a face insert coupled to the body and including a face portion and a sole portion that wrap around the sole weight bar, wherein a gap is disposed between the sole weight bar and the face insert, wherein the gap extends entirely about an outer periphery of the sole weight bar and is disposed between the sole weight bar and each of the face portion, the sole portion, and a back portion of the body, wherein the gap defines: a first thickness between the face portion of the face insert and a first face of the sole weight bar; and a second thickness between the back portion of the body and a second face of the sole weight bar, and wherein the first thickness and the second thickness are each less than a thickness of the sole weight bar measured between the first face and the second face along a front-rear direction.

9. The iron-type golf club head of claim 8, wherein a weight is disposed within a weight cavity of the sole weight bar.

10. The iron-type golf club head of claim 9, wherein the weight comprises a higher density material than a material of the body.

11. The iron-type golf club head of claim 8, wherein the sole weight bar is coupled to the body at a first location within the toe region and at a second location within the heel region.

12. The iron-type golf club head of claim 8, wherein the sole weight bar comprises a front face and a rear face, and wherein an acute angle is defined between a first point on the front face and a second point on the rear face.

13. The iron-type golf club head of claim 8, wherein the face portion, the sole portion, and the back portion define a U-shaped cavity that extends entirely about the sole weight bar.

14. The iron-type golf club head of claim 8, wherein the sole defines a toe segment, a medial segment, and a heel segment, wherein the sole portion of the face insert at least partially defines the medial segment of the sole.

15. An iron-type golf club head, comprising: a body including a toe region and a heel region, the toe region and the heel region each defining a portion of a top line and a portion of a sole of the iron-type golf club head; a sole weight bar extending between the toe region and the heel region; and a face insert coupled to the body at an interface between the face insert and the body, wherein the sole defines a toe segment, a medial segment, and a heel segment, wherein the face insert includes a face portion and a sole portion that wrap around the sole weight bar, the sole portion at least partially defining the medial segment of the sole, wherein a gap is disposed between the sole weight bar and the face insert, wherein the gap extends entirely about an outer periphery of the sole weight bar and is disposed between the sole weight bar and each of the face portion, the sole portion, and a back portion of the body, wherein the gap defines: a first thickness between the face

portion of the face insert and a first face of the sole weight bar; and a second thickness between the back portion of the body and a second face of the sole weight bar, and wherein the first thickness and the second thickness are each less than a thickness of the sole weight bar measured between the first face and the second face along a front-rear direction.

16. The iron-type golf club head of claim 15, wherein the sole weight bar is positioned entirely below a geometric center point of the face portion of the face insert, and wherein a weight is disposed within a weight cavity of the sole weight bar.

17. The iron-type golf club head of claim 16, wherein the body and the weight comprise different materials.

18. The iron-type golf club head of claim 15, wherein the body defines a medial region, and wherein the sole weight bar extends through the medial region.

19. The iron-type golf club head of claim 15, wherein the sole weight bar is coupled to the body at a first location within the toe region and at a second location within the heel region.

20. The iron-type golf club head of claim 15, wherein a sole surface of the sole weight bar and the sole portion are convexly curved in the front-rear direction relative to a ground plane.
